Question 27

GH-300: Advanced Prompting

What is 'Zero-Shot' vs 'Few-Shot' prompting in the context of guiding GitHub Copilot?

A. Zero-shot uses no context files; few-shot opens all workspace files.

✔ **B. Zero-shot provides a direct task request without examples; few-shot provides one or more concrete input/output examples inside the prompt.**

C. Zero-shot is used for Chat; few-shot is used exclusively for CLI commands.

D. Zero-shot requires custom fine-tuning; few-shot uses base public models.

Correct Answer: B

In prompt engineering: **Zero-Shot** asking tells the model what to do without providing examples (e.g., "Write a function to sanitize user input"). **Few-Shot** prompting supplies one or more examples showing expected input and output structures, significantly improving completion accuracy for complex tasks.

Option Breakdown

- **A. Context files usage:** Incorrect. Zero/few-shot refers to example demonstrations within the prompt itself, not tab states.
- **B. Direct request vs input/output examples:** Correct. Few-shot gives concrete sample pairs to establish output patterns.
- **C. Chat vs CLI distinction:** Incorrect. Both prompting styles apply across IDE inline completions, Chat, and CLI interfaces.
- **D. Fine-tuning requirement:** Incorrect. Few-shot prompting works dynamically within standard model context windows without model training.

💡 **GH-300 Exam Tip**

If Copilot produces incorrect syntax structure, switch from a Zero-shot comment to a **Few-shot** comment that includes 1 or 2 sample transformations before the target line.